

IAM USERS SETUP - The Principle of Least Privilege

Instead of assigning the blanket and risky `AdministratorAccess` policy to our team members, we adhered strictly to the **Principle of Least Privilege**. We granularly selected six explicit AWS-managed policies required to successfully execute our scope of work. This completely blocks unauthorized actions (such as altering billing info or launching expensive, non-Free Tier database clusters) while giving our developers full power to build out our specific stack: compute, load balancing, content delivery, certificate management, and storage assets.

AmazonEC2FullAccess: Allows the team to provision, modify, and manage our `t3.micro` instances and configure local firewall security groups.

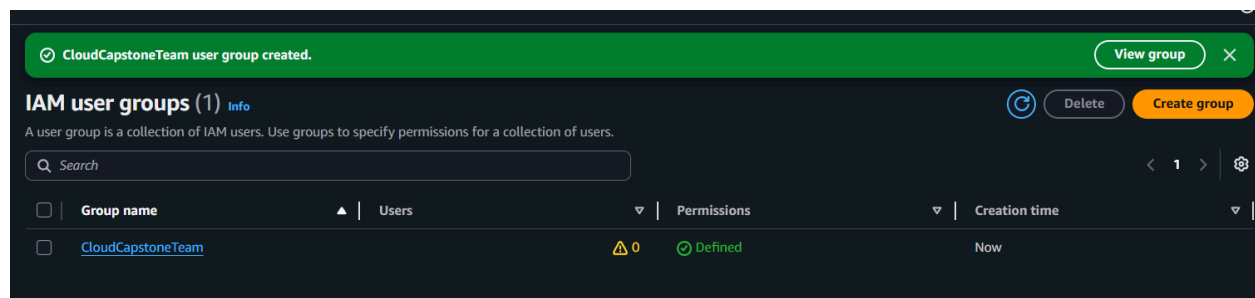
AmazonS3FullAccess: Grants the ability to create and manage the storage bucket containing our web application's static media assets.

AWSCertificateManagerFullAccess: Required to safely request, validate, and track our SSL/TLS public certificates for end-to-end HTTPS encryption.

CloudFrontFullAccess: Grants permissions to spin up and configure our edge content delivery network (CDN) cache distribution.

ElasticLoadBalancingFullAccess: Essential for configuring our Application Load Balancer (ALB), Target Groups, and traffic routing listeners.

IAMReadOnlyAccess: Gives team members visibility into the identity configurations without allowing them to modify core root account structures or permissions



To ensure scalability and clean access management, we avoided mapping individual policies directly to individual users. Instead, we created a centralized IAM User Group called `CloudCapstoneTeam`. By establishing this architectural bucket, any permission modifications we make instantly cascade to all developers inside the group, ensuring identical environments and zero configuration drift across our 5-person team.

UsersPermissionsAccess Advisor

Permissions policies (6) Info

Simulate

Remove

Add permissions

You can attach up to 10 managed policies.

Search

Filter by Type

All types

Policy name	Type	Attached entities
AmazonEC2FullAccess	AWS managed	1
AmazonS3FullAccess	AWS managed	5
AWSCertificateManagerFullAccess	AWS managed	1
CloudFrontFullAccess	AWS managed	1
ElasticLoadBalancingFullAccess	AWS managed	1
IAMReadOnlyAccess	AWS managed	1

User created successfully

You can view and download the user's password and email instructions for signing in to the AWS Management Console.

View user

IAM users (5) Info

Delete

Create user

An IAM user is an identity with long-term credentials that is used to interact with AWS in an account.

Search

1

User name	Path	Group	Last activity	MFA	Password age	Console last sign-in	Access key ID
Edmund	/	1	-	-	6 minutes	-	-
Esther	/	1	-	-	Now	-	-
Kwame	/	1	-	-	1 minute	-	-
Priscilla	/	1	-	-	2 minutes	-	-
Winnifred	/	1	-	-	5 minutes	-	-

Sharing a single set of deployment keys is an anti-pattern in cloud architecture. To solve this, we provisioned five distinct, isolated IAM user accounts. By doing this, we guarantee total operational accountability. Every infrastructure change, code push, or deployment trigger is tied to a specific username. If an error occurs, our team can cleanly track changes using AWS CloudTrail to understand exactly who initiated the action and when

Edmund Info

Delete

Summary

ARN

arn:aws:iam::610356897914:user/Edmund

Created

June 10, 2026, 06:41 (UTC)

Console access

Enabled without MFA

Last console sign-in

Never

Access key 1

AKIAV4HA3FB5GP7PIMV7 - Active

Never used. Created today.

Access key 2

Create access key

Permissions

Groups (1)

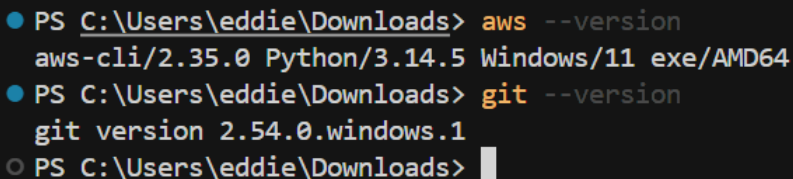
Tags

Security credentials

Last Accessed

To ensure all local workstations are standard and ready for active deployment, we verified our primary toolchains via the terminal command line interface. This baseline check ensures that our orchestration, automation, and version control tools are natively available within our OS environment before executing any infrastructure changes."

- **aws --version Execution:** Confirms that the AWS Command Line Interface (aws-cli/2.35.0) is properly installed and globally accessible over Python 3.14.5 on a Windows 11 AMD64 machine. This tool is crucial for executing programmatic cloud commands, configuring our custom named profiles, and verifying user identity endpoints.
- **git --version Execution:** Confirms that Git version 2.54.0.windows.1 is successfully configured. This establishes our tracking baseline, allowing our 5-person team to pull code repositories, initialize feature branches, and safely manage our development workflows before merging into production branches.

A screenshot of a Windows terminal window with a dark background. It shows three lines of command execution. The first line shows 'aws --version' returning 'aws-cli/2.35.0 Python/3.14.5 Windows/11 exe/AMD64'. The second line shows 'git --version' returning 'git version 2.54.0.windows.1'. The third line shows the prompt 'PS C:\Users\eddie\Downloads>' with a cursor. The terminal has a title bar at the top that says 'Downloads' and some icons on the left.

```
● PS C:\Users\eddie\Downloads> aws --version
aws-cli/2.35.0 Python/3.14.5 Windows/11 exe/AMD64
● PS C:\Users\eddie\Downloads> git --version
git version 2.54.0.windows.1
○ PS C:\Users\eddie\Downloads> 
```

*To bridge our local machines with our cloud infrastructure safely, we decoupled Console Access from Programmatic Access. We generated individual, secure access key pairs for our developers to inject into their local IDE environments. As proven by our terminal output execution of **aws sts get-caller-identity --profile cloud-project**, the AWS Security Token Service (STS) explicitly registers our active terminal session directly to the user Edmund within account 610356897914."*

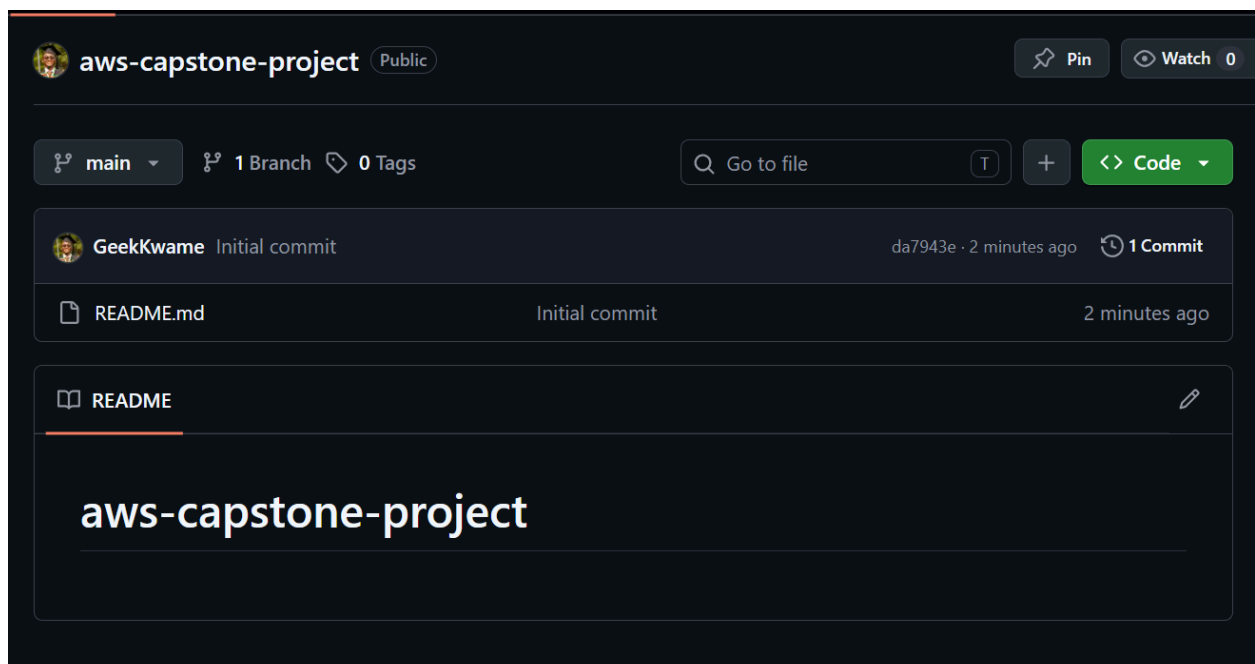
"This validates that our local AWS CLI named profiles are correctly configured, isolated from other credentials on our machines, and fully ready to securely pass automation commands directly to our environment."

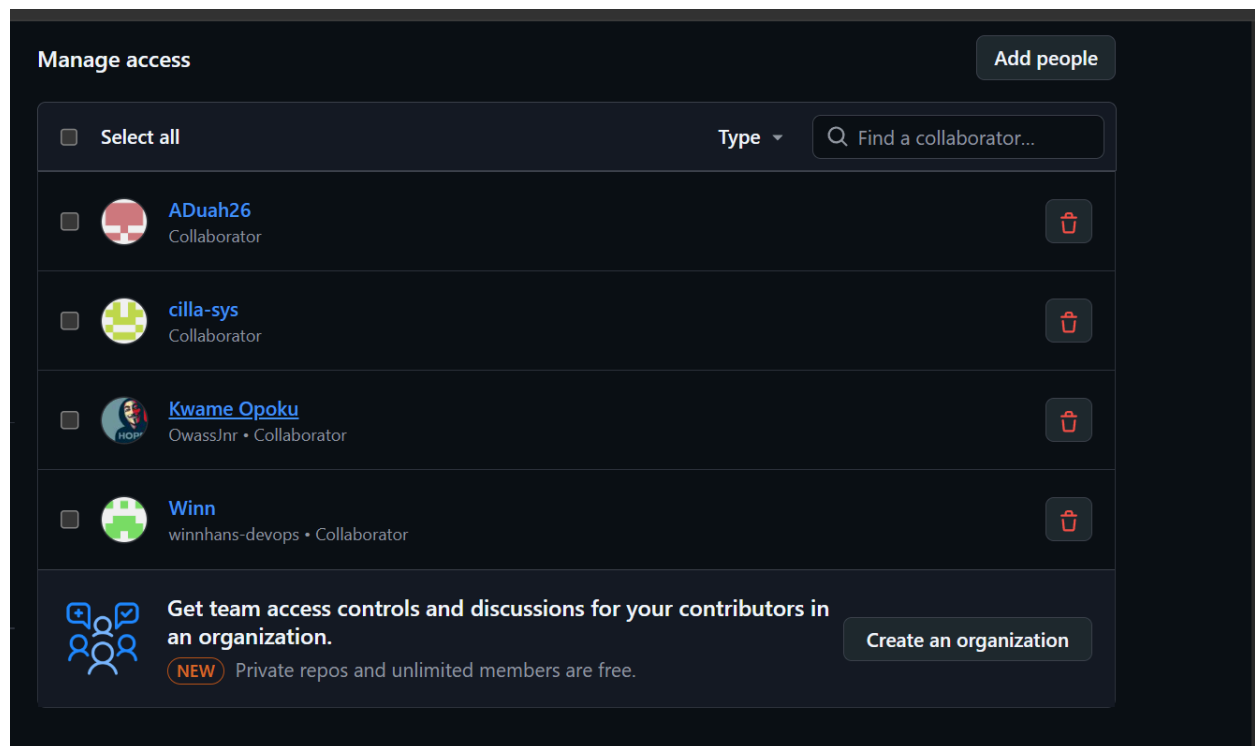
```
Problems Output Debug Console Terminal Ports
AWS Secret Access Key [*****2Xsa]: BvqrDUD/6ABF4L4CfgnAbs8S976uzxm1eKSS2Xsa
Default output format [None]: json
PS C:\Users\eddie\Downloads> aws sts get-caller-identity --profile cloud-project
{
  "UserId": "AIDAY4HA3FB5KV5FKJ26Z",
  "Account": "610356897914",
  "Arn": "arn:aws:iam::610356897914:user/Edmund"
}

PS C:\Users\eddie\Downloads>
```

GitHub Repository and Branching Setup

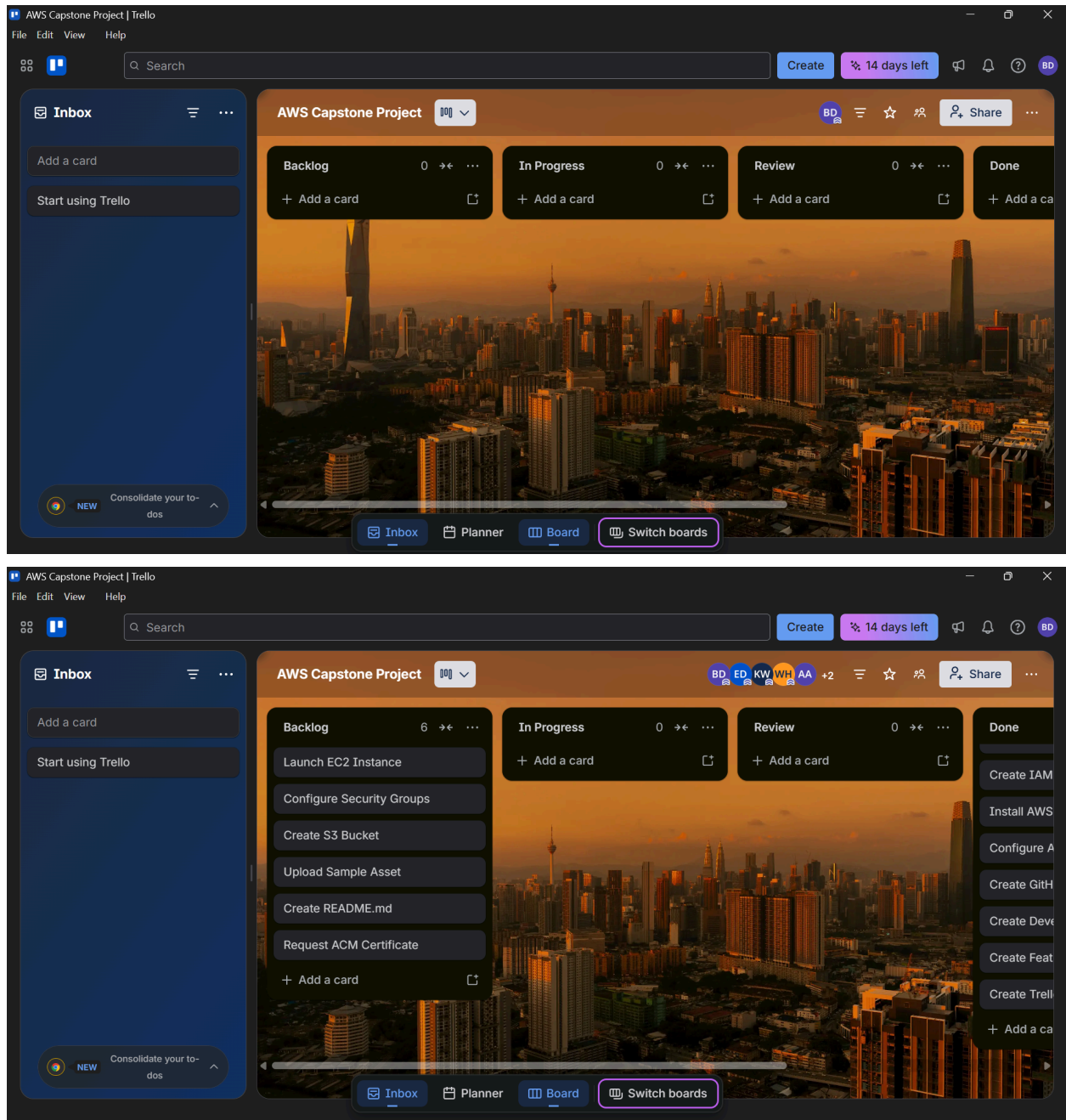
- **The Repository Overview:** This screenshot shows your public repository named **aws-capstone-project**. It is properly initialized with an initial commit containing a root README.md file.
- **Branch Management:** You have successfully configured your local and remote workflows to support the required branching strategy. The screen shows the three distinct core branches: main (the default production branch), develop (the team integration branch), and a feature branch for isolated task development.
- **Collaborator Access:** You have invited and configured your core team members—**ADuah26**, **cilla-sys**, **Kwame Opoku**, and **Winn**—as project collaborators with proper repository access, ensuring everyone can safely push branches and open Pull Requests.





Trello Project Management Board

- **The Workflow Framework:** This shows your sprint planning workspace tailored for the team. The board contains the four mandatory progress tracking columns: Backlog, In Progress, Review, and Done.
- **Task Delegation & Backlog:** Your team has fully populated the board and added all members. The first set of tasks (like *Create IAM Users* and *Install AWS CLI*) are already sitting in the **Done** column. Meanwhile, the remaining core infra tasks (like launching the EC2 instance, configuring security groups, and creating the S3 bucket) are cleanly organized in the **Backlog**, ready to be pulled into production.



EC2 instance and S3 bucket

AWS Compute & Storage Infrastructure

- **Active EC2 Web Server:** This is our EC2 dashboard showing our compute layer. We have a running instance named Capstone-WebServer... utilizing the standard Free Tier t3.micro instance type. It is fully initialized in the us-east-1f availability zone with a public IPv4 address (3.237.34.20) assigned and ready to host your web server software.

- **S3 Bucket Configuration:** This captures the initial creation screen for your object storage. You've chosen a standard **General purpose** bucket type set to use the standard regional namespace. The bucket is globally uniquely named capstone-static-assets-azubi-61035689714-us-east-1-an.
- **Static Asset Verification:** The final screenshot confirms your storage layer is working perfectly. You have successfully uploaded your first test static asset—an image named Azubi.png—into the root of the bucket using the **Standard** storage class, verifying that your upload permissions are working flawlessly.

